Module 6 Project Scenarios:

According to the EPA and most everyone in the water/wastewater industry, there is a significant shortage of people heading into careers in the water and wastewater industry. Currently, the median age for water/wastewater operators is approaching 50 years old, meaning that most operators are close to retirement age. Having looked through a few of the online career/occupation inventories, it appears that careers in water and wastewater – or even careers in utilities – are seldom mentioned as far as modern career clusters are concerned. Luckily, the US Bureau of Labor Statistics (USBLS) maintains an online publication, the Occupational Outlook Handbook, which is updated annually and lists just about any occupation you can think of, and anything you might want to know about water and wastewater careers or related careers can be found there.

Interestingly, according to the USBLS, the job outlook for water/wastewater operators is expected to decline from 2020-2030 by 3%, which appears to be in direct conflict with the EPA's outlook that this same industry is experiencing a serious shortage of career employees. Both outlooks are based on solid data, and both are true – so how can this career field be shrinking while also be in dire need of more workers?

Your mission, should you accept it, is to figure out the answer to the above question while also determining if a career in water/wastewater or a water-related career is right for you.